

Lars Schöbitz - CV

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2026-07-21

Environmental engineer and data scientist working in the global water, sanitation and health (WASH) sector. Open Science Specialist at ETH Zurich. I build open-data communities and teach reproducible data science with R and Quarto. TODO: review this intro.

Contact

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Languages

German (native)

English (fluent)

French

Spanish

Work Experience

Education

Open Data & Software

fairenough - tidy data into documented R packages

Author

2025 - Current

- Converts tidy data into R packages with documentation websites and AI-assisted descriptions.

jmpwashdata - WHO/UNICEF JMP data

Author

2024 - Current

- R package providing tidy access to WHO/UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme WASH data.

Data Science for openwashdata (ds4owd)

Course Creator & Instructor

2023 - Current

I build and maintain open-data communities and FAIR data tooling.

- Designed and taught two free online cohorts on literate programming with Quarto and R; hundreds of participants across many countries.
- Focus on data management, reproducibility and publishing open data.

washr - R package for publishing openwashdata resources

Author

2023 - Current

- An R package that makes publishing openwashdata data resources easier.

openwashdata community

Founder & Community Lead

2022 - Current

- Built and lead a global open-data community for the WASH sector; 90+ open datasets published as documented R data packages.
- Created the {washr} and {fairenough} R packages that turn tidy data into FAIR, documented data packages.
- See openwashdata.org

rstatsZH - R training for the Canton of Zurich

Course Creator & Instructor

2021 - Current

- Built and ran the R training programme for the cantonal administration of Zurich (rstatsZH), including course website and material.

Teaching

Workshops

Talks

Publications

Light absorbing carbonaceous aerosols: Concentrations and sources in an under-monitored region

Ecotoxicology and Environmental Safety

2025

- Co-author. Peer-reviewed journal article.

Estimating Safely Managed Sanitation in Urban Areas; Lessons Learned From a Global Implementation of Excreta-Flow Diagrams

Frontiers in Environmental Science

2020

I am passionate about teaching reproducible data science to newcomers.

- Peer-reviewed journal article on SDG 6.2 monitoring.

Towards an off-grid fecal sludge treatment unit: demonstrating energy positive thermal treatment

Gates Open Research

2019

- Peer-reviewed journal article.

Methods to reliably estimate faecal sludge quantities and qualities for the design of treatment infrastructure

Journal of Environmental Management

2018

- Peer-reviewed journal article.

GIS Analysis and Optimisation of Faecal Sludge Logistics at City-Wide Scale in Kampala, Uganda

Sustainability

2017

- Peer-reviewed journal article.

FAQ: Faecal sludge quantification and characterization - field trial of methodology in Kampala, Uganda

Sandec News

2014

- Journal article.

Conference Papers

Remote Sensing, Mobile Applications and Open Data Science Tools for Better Monitoring and Evaluation of Sanitation Services

HIC 2018, 13th International Conference on Hydroinformatics

2018

- Conference paper.

FAQ: Faecal Sludge Quantification and Characterization - field trial of methodology

37th WEDC International Conference

2014

- Conference paper.

Technical Reports

SFD Promotion Initiative - Final Reports (7 cities)

Sustainable Sanitation Alliance / Eawag-Sandec

2016 - 2015

- Lead / co-author of Shit Flow Diagram (SFD) reports for Bignona (SN), Hanoi & Danang (VN), Kampala (UG), Dar es Salaam (TZ), Khulna (BD), Nonthaburi (TH).

RRR-Project: From Research to Implementation, Component 1 - Waste Supply and Availability

Eawag-Sandec

2014

- Technical report on resource recovery and reuse.

Professional Roles

Member, Data Stewardship Network

ETH Zurich

TODO - Current

- TODO: confirm start year and describe your role in the network.

Local Node, Swiss Reproducibility Network (SwissRN)

ETH Zurich

TODO - Current

- Local node representative for SwissRN at ETH Zurich. TODO: confirm start year.

References